



PUBLIC SAFETY CADETS

RICHARDSON POLICE DEPARTMENT

STATEMENT OF UNDERSTANDING

G.O. 1.00.41-001
05/16/08

I have been given and read the Department General Order G.O. 1.00.41-98 regarding the Cadet Program. I understand what the Program is about and the limitations of the Cadets during the Ride-Along. Additionally, I understand that there will be no inappropriate or unprofessional contact between any Cadet and myself. If an instance should arise where the Cadet is not within the Program guidelines, the situation will be documented and reported to the Executive Advisor or an Associate Advisor. If the Cadet should perform an act that is commendable, the act should also be documented and reported to the Executive Advisor or an Associate Advisor. Any questions regarding the program can be directed toward the Executive Advisor or an Associate Advisor.

Officer's Signature ID#

Officer's Printed Name

Date



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RIDE-ALONG PROGRAM — GENERAL ORDER

Section 9: Ride-Along Program

9.01.00-98

Purpose

Cadets will be given the opportunity to participate in the Ride-Along Program, which is sponsored by the Department. The purpose of the Ride-Along Program is to provide the Cadet with a firsthand knowledge of the patrol function as well as a broader knowledge of basic police procedures. Additionally, the Program supplements classroom training in basic law enforcement operations through observation and conversation with police officers during their performance of patrol functions.

9.02.00-98

Eligibility and Requirements

For a Cadet to be eligible for the Ride-Along Program, the Cadet must meet the following requirements:

9.02.01-98

The Cadet must be at least sixteen (16) years of age, an active member of the Cadet program in good standing, and be approved by an Advisor for participation.

9.02.02-98

The Cadet must have satisfactorily completed the Basic Law Enforcement Training Program with a minimum average score of 80 percentile (as described in G.O. 8.01.00-98).

9.02.03-98

The Cadet must have a signed and notarized "Release of Liability" (as described in G.O. 3.04.00-98) on file with the Advisors.

9.02.04-98

The Cadet must forward a "Ride-Along Request" to the Advisors, through the Chain of Command, at least one week prior to the Ride-Along.

9.02.05-98

Cadets will not be permitted to ride with the same officer for more than 8 hours during a 30-day period.



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- 9.02.06-98** The Cadet must be in a clean, pressed, and complete uniform when participating in a Ride-Along.
- 9.02.07-98** The Cadet is to ride only with the officer to whom he is assigned to ride with. Cadets should ride with an Advisor or Field Training Officer for the first two Ride-Alongs.
- 9.02.08-98** The Cadet must arrive and report to Patrol Operations fifteen (15) minutes prior to the scheduled Ride-Along briefing.
- 9.02.09-98** At the end of the shift, the Cadet will submit a "Performance Evaluation" for the Ride-Along officer to complete, which will be turned into the Advisors once completed.
- 9.03.00-98** **Scheduling**
Cadets participating in the Ride-Along program will be allowed to ride for a maximum of sixteen (16) hours per month. The Cadet must ride a minimum of four (4) hours and a maximum of eight (8) hours per day.
- 9.03.01-98** Times for the Ride-Along Program will be determined by the age of the Cadet, the Advisors, and the Watch Commanders.
- 9.03.02-98** The following are the times permitted for Ride-Alongs by age:
- 16 years of age: Second Watch and Third Watch
 - 17 years of age: Second, Third, and Fourth Watch
 - 18 – 21 years of age: First, Second, Third, and Fourth Watch
- 9.04.00-98** **Officer Qualifications and Selection**
The Cadet will be permitted to ride with volunteer patrol officers that have completed the following requirements:
- Have a minimum of one (1) year patrol experience with RPD.
 - Have prior approval from their immediate supervisor.
 - Serves as a positive representative of the Department.
 - Has a signed "Statement of Understanding" on file with the Executive Advisor.
- The approval for Ride-Along officers will be made by the Cadet Advisors and is subject to change at any time.



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RIDE-ALONG PROGRAM — GENERAL ORDER

9.05.00-98

Advisor Duties and Responsibilities

The Advisors will have the following responsibilities for the Ride-Along Program:

9.05.01-98

The Advisors will be responsible for ensuring all rules, regulations, and other applicable procedures for the Ride-Along program are followed.

9.05.02-98

The Executive Advisor will obtain from each Cadet eligible to participate in the Ride-Along Program a "Release of Liability". This release must be signed and notarized and kept on file.

9.05.03-98

The Executive Advisor will obtain from each Cadet eligible to participate in the Ride-Along Program a medical release authorizing any Richardson police officer to consent to emergency medical treatment.

9.05.04-98

The Executive Advisor will obtain from each patrol officer participating in the Ride-Along Program a "Statement of Understanding". This statement must be signed and kept on file.

9.06.00-98

Officer Duties and Responsibilities

The Ride-Along officer has the following responsibilities:

9.06.01-98

The Ride-Along officer is responsible for the safety and wellbeing of the Cadet during the Ride-Along.

9.06.02-98

The officer will submit a "Statement of Understanding" to the Executive Advisor upon being selected as an approved Ride-Along officer.

9.06.03-98

The Ride-Along officer shall notify his supervisor and the Cadet Advisors should any problems occur during the Ride-Along.



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RIDE-ALONG PROGRAM — GENERAL ORDER

9.07.00-98

Cadet Duties and Responsibilities

The Cadet participates in the Ride-Along Program as an observer in a non-law enforcement capacity. A Cadet must follow the assigned officer's directions regardless of his personal feelings or prior training.

9.07.01-98

During a Ride-Along, Cadets may fulfill various duties as determined by the officer. These may include, but are not limited to the following:

- Traffic or Crowd Control
- Radio Operation
- Assisting a Motorist
- Completing routine paperwork that will not be used in any court action
- Protection of a crime scene
- Act as an interpreter, as needed

9.08.00-98

High-Risk Call Procedure

When responding to a high-risk call, the Ride-Along officer will utilize his best discretion regarding the Cadet's and officer's safety. The officer may leave the Cadet at the first safe location and proceed to the high-risk call. The officer will immediately inform Communications of the Cadet's location. In the event this is not feasible, the Cadet will remain in the police vehicle until directed by the Ride-Along officer that the situation is safe and under control.

9.09.00-98

Limitation of Involvement

A Cadet is prohibited from certain actions when he is participating in the Ride-Along Program. Some specific functions include:

- Interviewing or interrogating witnesses or suspects.
- Will not detain, arrest, or restrain an individual.
- Leaving the police vehicle, unless so instructed by the Ride-Along officer.
- Being armed in any manner.
- Signing any legal document, such as any arrest, offense, accident report, traffic citation, etc.



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RIDE-ALONG PROGRAM — GENERAL ORDER

- Assisting in providing cover for any possible crime in progress.
- Driving any vehicles.
- Riding with members of SID, Motorcycles, or SWAT.
- Any other behavior or activity that the Cadet has been notified of by an Advisor, the Ride-Along officer or a supervisor as being prohibited.

9.10.00-98

Termination of a Ride-Along

The Ride-Along officer or a Department supervisor has the authority to terminate a Ride-Along at any time for any reason. The termination of a Ride-Along will be reported to an Advisor as soon as practical. The termination will be investigated by the Cadet Program Advisors, and the final disposition should be routed to the officer/supervisor originating the termination.



RICHARDSON POLICE DEPARTMENT



GENERAL ORDER

- I. PURPOSE
- II. POLICY
- III. PROCEDURE
- IV. EFFECTIVE DATE

I. PURPOSE:

The purpose of this Order is to define the Richardson Police Department Law Enforcement Explorer Program, the selection and responsibilities of the Explorer Advisors and the Explorer Ride-Along Program.

II. POLICY:

It is the policy of the Richardson Police Department to sponsor Explorer Post #761, a program designed in conjunction with the Boy Scouts of America (BSA) / Learning for Life, to educate and involve our youth in law enforcement, to instill leadership and integrity, and to promote a positive interaction with the Police Department and the community.

III. PROCEDURE:

A. Chain of Command and Departmental Roles in the Explorer Program

1. Chief of Police

- a. Serves as the official sponsored organization representative for the Explorer Program.
- b. Approves all Advisor selections and appointments.

2. The Captain of Patrol Operations oversees all Explorer Program operations.

3. Executive Post Advisor

- a. Oversees developing procedures and rules governing Explorer uniforms, training and conduct.
- b. Serves as the liaison between the Explorer Program, Associate Advisors, Consultants, BSA and the Captain of Patrol Operations.
- c. Maintains contact with the BSA and ensures that the Explorer Program is operating within BSA guidelines.

- d. Submits a quarterly Explorer Activity Report through the chain of command to the Chief of Police.
 - e. Responsible for the daily operation of the Explorer Program and oversees all Explorer Program functions.
 - 4. Associate Post Advisors
 - a. Assists the Executive Advisor in the Explorer Program operations.
 - b. Assumes the command of the Explorer Program in the absence of the Executive Advisor.
 - 5. Consultants are individuals outside the Explorer Program who are recruited for brief periods of time, due to their levels of expertise in the field of law enforcement.
- B. Qualifications for Law Enforcement Explorer Participation
- 1. Law Enforcement Explorers are young adults, between the ages of 14 and 21, who are interested in pursuing a career in law enforcement.
 - 2. Participants in the Law Enforcement Explorer Program must have completed and filed with the Executive Advisor the appropriate Release of Liability and Indemnity, medical release and permission forms.
 - a. Parent Permission / Consent to Medical Treatment ([G.O. 1.00.41-002](#))
 - b. Release of Liability for Adult ([G.O. 1.00.41-003](#))
 - c. Release of Liability and Indemnity Agreement for Minor – Married Parents ([G.O. 1.00.41-004](#))
 - d. Release of Liability and Indemnity for Minor – Divorced Parents ([G.O. 1.00.41-005](#))
 - e. Police Training Center Release of Liability and Indemnification ([G.O. 1.00.41-006](#))
- C. Qualifications for Explorer Advisors Positions
- 1. In order to be considered for the position of Executive Advisor, the employee must:
 - a. be the rank of sergeant or higher;
 - b. commit to a two-year position as Executive Advisor; and
 - c. maintain a performance appraisal rating at Level III or better.
 - 2. In order to be considered for the position of Associate Advisor, the employee must:
 - a. have two years prior RPD experience; and
 - b. maintain a performance appraisal rating at Level III or better.

D. Explorer Advisors Selection Procedures

1. Executive Advisor

- a. The Executive Advisor shall be chosen from those sworn supervisors who have served as an Associate Advisor whenever possible.
- b. The Chief of Police will have final authority for the selection of the Executive Advisor.
- c. An Employee Request (G.O. 1.00.16-001) may be submitted to the Chief of Police stating the desire for the position, along with copies of their last two performance appraisal.

2. Associate Advisor

- a. Any departmental employee may submit an Employee Request to the Executive Advisor stating the desire for the position, along with the employee's last performance evaluation.
- b. The Executive Advisor will forward the Employee Request along with the selection recommendation to the Chief of Police.
- c. The Chief of Police will have final authority for the selection of an Associate Advisor.

3. Upon being selected, an Advisor must become "Youth Protection" certified through the BSA / Learning for Life and attend an Explorer Advisor workshop as soon as practical. The Certificate will be kept on file by the Executive Advisor.

4. Employees selected as Advisors will be permitted to wear on their uniform the Department approved insignia for Explorer Advisors.

E. Advisor Conduct

1. Explorer Advisors must conduct themselves in a professional manner at all times when acting as an Advisor.
2. Fraternization with an Explorer is strictly prohibited and anyone doing so will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

F. Advisor Compensation

1. Time spent on Explorer Post activities is considered duty time.
2. Associate Advisors may be authorized up to 8 hours of Special Assignment time per month for Explorer activities.
3. The Executive Advisor may be authorized up to 12 hours of Special Assignment time per month for Explorer activities.

4. Total Special Assignment time for all Advisors combined will not exceed forty (40) hours per month.
5. Advisors are required to coordinate their Explorer SA time through their immediate supervisor. Supervisors should make efforts to assist Advisors in Explorer activities; however, primary duty assignments take precedence.
6. The Explorer Advisors will be authorized a combined total of forty-eight (48) Special Assignment Days per year for Explorer Competition activities. The scheduling of such requires supervisory coordination and assistance.
7. The Executive Advisor is responsible for maintaining records of special assignment time for all advisors to meet compliance with this order.
8. Explorer Advisors will not receive or utilize any Explorer Program funds for compensation or reimbursement for personal time.

G. Explorer Department Authorized Activities

1. Although the main emphasis of Law Enforcement Exploring is the participation in the Ride-Along program, Explorers are also involved in other departmental operations.
2. Explorers assist departmental personnel in numerous divisions, operate at citywide functions and participate in special events. See Attachment A for special events assignments.
3. Ride-Along Program
 - a. Explorers will be given the opportunity to participate in the Ride-Along Program, which is sponsored by this Department and certified by the BSA.
 - b. The purpose of the Ride-Along Program is to provide the Explorer with a firsthand knowledge of the patrol function as well as a broader knowledge of basic police procedures.
 - c. The Program supplements classroom training in basic law enforcement operations through observation and conversation with police officers during their performance of patrol functions.
 - d. Explorers will be permitted to ride with volunteer patrol officers that have completed the following requirements:
 - 1) A minimum of one year patrol experience with the Department following probation;
 - 2) Prior approval from their immediate supervisor;
 - 3) Recognized as a positive representative of the Department;

- 4) A signed Statement of Understanding (G.O. 1.00.41-001) on file with the Executive Advisor; and
 - 5) Maintain a performance appraisal rating at Level III or better.
- e. The Ride-Along Officer or a department supervisor has the authority to terminate a Ride-Along at any time for any reason.
- 1) The termination of a Ride-Along will be reported to an Advisor as soon as practical.
 - 2) The termination will be investigated by the Explorer Program Advisors, and the final disposition should be routed to the officer/supervisor originating the termination.
- f. No Explorer, whether in uniform or not, will drive a marked patrol vehicle, unless in a life-threatening emergency or as instructed during training.
- g. While responding to a high-risk call, the Ride-Along officer will utilize his best discretion regarding the Explorer's and officer's safety.
- 1) The officer may leave the Explorer at the first safe location and proceed to the high-risk call.
 - 2) The officer will immediately inform Communications of the Explorer's location.
 - 3) In the event this is not feasible, the Explorer will remain in the police vehicle until directed by the Ride-Along officer that the situation is safe and under control.
- h. Explorers under the age of eighteen (18) may not ride between the hours of 2300 and 0600.

H. Use of Explorers in Covert Operations

1. When the Department is conducting an undercover investigation involving alcohol, tobacco, or volatile chemicals, the investigating unit may seek the voluntary support of Explorers as private citizens, but not as official members of the Explorer Program. This requires written parental approval for those under the age of 18.
2. Any other covert operation must be approved by the Operations Bureau Assistant Chief and will only be considered when no other alternative manpower is available.
3. The Department will be solely responsible for any civil damages and legal or medical complications that might arise from such an investigation.

IV. EFFECTIVE DATE: October 31, 1998 REVISED: May 16, 2008

Larry Zacharias
Chief of Police
Richardson Police Department

Attachment A - Special Assignment Events

FORMS ORIGINATING FROM THIS POLICY

- G.O. 1.00.41-001 - Statement of Understanding for Officers Participating in the Ride-Along Program
- G.O. 1.00.41-002 - Parent Permission / Consent to Medical Treatment
- G.O. 1.00.41-003 - Release of Liability – Adult
- G.O. 1.00.41-004 - Release of Liability and Indemnity Agreement for Minor – Married Parents
- G.O. 1.00.41-005 - Release of Liability and Indemnity Agreement for Minor – Divorced Parents
- G.O. 1.00.41-006 - Police Training Center - Release of Liability and Indemnification

ATTACHMENT A

Special Assignment Events

National Competition	4 Advisors x 5 days	=	20 days
Regional Competitions (3)	4 Advisors x 1 day x 3	=	12 days
Ropes Course Training	4 Advisors x 1 day	=	4 days
Dallas After Dark	4 Advisors x 1 day	=	4 days
Learning for Life Events	4 Advisors x 2 days	=	8 days

Total Combined Special Assignment Days = 48 days